



Historic haul: Kranti Gaud became the first woman to earn a place on the Lord's Test honours board, her incisive spell of 5 for 37 exposing England's batting with relentless accuracy.

REUTERS

cricket, a format unfamiliar to many of the younger players. Meanwhile, a defeat to Australia in its final group match had already ended India's hopes of reaching the semifinals. That meant Harmanpreet Kaur's women could take a breather and focus on Test cricket. It seemed they

were better off because of that. India outplayed England in every aspect of the game.

After being put into bat, India made 285 in the first innings, riding on fifties from Smriti Mandhana, Harmanpreet and Deepti Sharma. The Indian batters punished the

undisciplined England attack.

That total seemed even bigger than it actually was, thanks to a superb spell of pace bowling from Kranti Gaud. She bowled with good pace and got her line and length right. She attacked the stumps relentlessly and was rewarded with a

« The MCC, which had resisted women's membership for so long, threw its weight behind promoting the women's Test »